SAMU - Rwanda Biomedical Centre

SAMU Roster

User manual

For the Administrator

About this manual

This manual explains everything the administrator does in SAMU Roster: setting up the system, building the roster, reviewing and publishing it, and handling changes afterwards.

In this manual

1. Your role
2. Signing in and getting around
3. Setting up (do this once, then keep it current)
4. Generating a roster
5. How a roster moves from draft to published
6. Reviewing and publishing
7. Changes after the roster exists
8. Reading the roster board
9. If something goes wrong

Version 1 - 24 October 2026 - This manual covers only what this role does.

Your role

As **administrator** you set up everything the roster depends on, build the whole roster, review it and publish it. You are the only role that can create accounts, edit staff, stations and leave, and publish.

You can	You cannot
Set up stations, ambulances, facilities, employees, leave and users	Change a published roster by regenerating it
Generate drivers, medical crew and dispatch together, or any part	Reopen a published roster (only a submitted one)
Check conflicts, submit, reopen, publish and delete rosters	Remove or demote the last active administrator
Replace crew members, set crew leaders, accept a short crew	
Create events, review command decisions, read the activity log	

Your menu

Group	Pages
Overview	Dashboard
Setup	Stations, Ambulances, Facilities
Workforce	Employees, Leave, Users
Planning	Generate Roster
Roster Board	Roster Board
Crew Operations	Crew Rollup, Mark Unavailable
Events	Events
Admin	Notifications, Activity Log, Command Decisions

Signing in and getting around

1. Open **https://ems-rw.duckdns.org** in a browser on a computer or phone.
2. Type your **username** and **password** exactly as given to you. The username is case sensitive and can contain a space.
3. Press **Sign in**.

> **IMPORTANT** After **5 wrong passwords** for the same username, sign-in is blocked for 15 minutes. You stay signed in for 12 hours, then you sign in again. There is no way to change your own password in the app: ask the administrator to set a new one.

On a phone

- Tap the **menu button** (three lines, top right). Groups with an arrow open when you tap them; tap a page and the menu closes.
- Lists appear as cards, one per person or record, with their buttons underneath. The roster grid scrolls sideways: swipe it.

Signing out and this manual

Log out and **User manual** are at the bottom of the menu, below your name. The manual you open is always the one for your role.

Setting up (do this once, then keep it current)

Set up in this order, because each step depends on the one before. The Dashboard card **Setup readiness** and the **Preflight check** on the Generate Roster page tell you what is still missing.

1. Stations

1. Open **Setup > Stations** and press **Add station**.
2. Fill **Station name**, **Code** (the number used in shift codes: code 3 produces D3 and N3; it must be unique), **Day crew size**, **Night crew size**, **Min drivers/crew** and **Runs nights** (turn it off for a day-only station). Press **Save**.

> **TIP** Minimum drivers per crew cannot be larger than the crew size. A station that already has roster history cannot be deleted: set it inactive instead.

2. Ambulances

Setup > Ambulances > add: **Plate no.**, **Type**, **Station** and **Status** (active, maintenance or out of service). Only active ambulances get crews. A crew placed on an ambulance that is later taken out of service shows up in Check conflicts.

3. Facilities (fixed posts)

Setup > Facilities lists non-ambulance posts, for example the call centre. Each has a **Required headcount**. People posted to a facility are a fixed assignment and are not part of the ambulance day and night rotation.

4. Employees

1. Open **Workforce > Employees** and press **Add employee**.
2. Fill **Name**, contact details and **Role**. Choose a **Home station** *or* a **facility posting**, never both.
3. Tick what applies: **Qualified driver**, **Team leader**, **Pro** (qualified to lead a crew; every crew needs one), **Floats freely** (may work at any station without a home-station preference), **Nights only (ad hoc)**, **Cleared for events**, and the night restriction option for anyone who may not work nights.
4. Press **Save**.

- New or imported people start with the role *unassigned*; the Dashboard shows how many **need a role**. **Bulk update** changes a role or flag for many people at once and shows a preview first.
- **Remove** deletes a person only if they were never used in a roster; otherwise the person is deactivated and kept for history.

5. Leave

1. Open **Workforce > Leave**. Choose the **Employee**, **From**, optional **To** and the **Type**.
2. Save. One record is created for each day in the range. Leave is never overridden by the generator.

Maternity leave (96 days) and paternity leave (7 days) show a warning when a block runs longer, but are never refused. Delete a wrong day from the list.

6. Users

1. Open **Workforce > Users** and press **Create user**.
2. Enter **Username**, **Password** (at least 8 characters, not only digits, not a common password) and the **Role**: admin, drivers_manager, phtl or call_center_tl.
3. To reset a password, deactivate someone, or change a role, press **Edit** on their row. The last active administrator can never be removed or demoted.

7. Standby settings

On **Generate Roster** press **Standby settings** to set how many reserve people each group (drivers, medical, call centre) keeps per day shift and per night shift. Zero means no standby team for that group.

Generating a roster

1. Open **Planning > Generate Roster**. Read the **Preflight check**. Fix blocking problems first; you can still choose **Generate anyway**, but the result will be poor.
2. Choose the **Range** (Day, Week, Month or Custom range) and the **Reference date**. The page shows the exact dates it will build.
3. Press **Generate roster**. The page shows **Solving - elapsed time**. A full roster takes about **10 to 15 minutes**. You can keep the page open or come back; the roster then appears under **Existing rosters** and on the Roster Board.
4. When it finishes you see the number of assignments, an **Overall quality** score and an **Overtime** indicator, and any coverage gaps.

- Choosing exactly the same dates as an existing draft adds to that draft. Dates that only partly overlap another roster are refused.
- As administrator you generate drivers, medical crew and the dispatch desk in one go. The three managers can also each generate their own part into the same draft.

How a roster moves from draft to published

Stage	What it means	Who acts
Draft	Being built. The three parts (drivers, medical crew, dispatch desk) can each be generated into the same draft.	Administrator and the three managers
Submitted	Sent for review. It is locked: nobody can generate into it.	Anyone who is signed in; an administrator can reopen it
Published	Final. Every person in it is notified. Later changes go through crew replacements, which notify the people affected.	Administrator only

Check conflicts on the Roster Board lists anything that would block publishing: a missing rest day, a person scheduled while inactive, a night shift for someone not cleared for nights, a leave day that was overridden, a crew with no Pro, or an ambulance that is not in service. Each line says how to fix it.

Reviewing and publishing

1. Open **Roster Board** and choose the roster. Read the grid and the status line.
2. Press **Check conflicts**. Fix everything listed under **Can't publish**. Items marked **Approved exception** were signed off by a manager and do not block.
3. Press **Submit for review**. You are warned if a part (drivers, medical crew, dispatch desk) was never generated.
4. Press **Publish**. Everyone in the roster is notified, including standby duty.
5. **Export to Excel** saves the grid as a spreadsheet.

- **Regenerate** rebuilds a draft (all parts). **Reopen to draft** returns a submitted roster to draft so a missing part can be generated.
- **Delete** is permanent. A submitted or published roster needs you to type its status to confirm.

Changes after the roster exists

Crew Operations > Crew Rollup shows station, ambulance and crew for a roster and a day. Besides replacing people (below):

- Click a Pro member's name to make them **crew leader**.
- The calendar-style button next to a person is **Pull for event**: it takes them off their crew for an event and leaves the crew short, with no replacement.
- The red button next to a driver is **Mark unavailable**: it opens Mark Unavailable for that person.

Replacing someone or accepting a gap: Handle shortage

1. Open **Crew Operations > Crew Rollup**, choose the roster and the day, then pick the station. Each ambulance shift is a card.
2. Press **Handle shortage** on the ambulance shift (it is next to the driver). A window opens: **Choose how to fill this seat**.

3. Under **Legal picks**, choose a person. Candidates are ranked by fairness, least-loaded first. **Home station only** and **Show ineligible too** filter the list. Press **Confirm crew replacement**. Both people are notified if the roster is already published.
4. If nobody is legal, **Risky picks - needs an override** lists people who would break a protected rule (for example a rest day or Pro coverage). Choose a reason, write a justification and type **OVERRIDE** to confirm.
5. If nobody can be found, under **Or: leave this crew short** press **Approve this crew to run with no driver**. Choose a reason and write a justification. Nobody is moved; the gap is accepted and logged.

> **IMPORTANT** Every risky pick and every accepted shortage is recorded under **Command Decisions** with your name, the reason and the justification. Safety-related ones are reviewed by the administrator.

For a **medical crew member**, press the swap button next to their name instead; the steps are the same, and the last option reads **Approve this crew to run short**.

Mark Unavailable

For one day when someone cannot work: **Crew Operations > Mark Unavailable**, choose the person and the day, press **Find their shift**, then fill the slot immediately.

Events, command decisions, activity

- **Events**: only you create and delete events. The Drivers Manager and PHTL plan their coverage; the Call Center is never affected.
- **Command Decisions** lists every deliberate rule break with who approved it and why. Use **Mark reviewed** for safety exceptions and **Mark resolved** when closed.
- **Activity Log** shows who did what and when. **Notifications** lists messages sent to you; press **Mark read**.

Reading the roster board

The board has one row per person and one column per day. Each cell holds a code. Colours: blue-tinted cells are day shifts, dark cells are night shifts, grey cells are days off, amber cells are leave or other absence, green cells are event duty.

Code	Meaning
D + number (D3)	Day shift at the station with that code
N + number (N3)	Night shift at the station with that code
DR / NR	Day / night shift at the Regulation desk (call centre desk)
DE / NE	Day / night event duty
O	Off
AL, SL, ML, PL	Annual leave, sick leave, maternity leave, paternity leave
TR, AD, P	Training, administration, permission
MS, ST, CY, CL	Mission, stock, cyclism, circumstance leave

Code	Meaning
DT, DM, DC, R	Data, day meeting, day checking, roster
SB	Standby

For fairness, a day shift counts as **10 hours** and a night shift as **14 hours**. The total on the right of each row is hours worked in the roster.

Rules the system applies when it builds a roster

- One shift per person per day. Leave is respected exactly as entered.
- The day after a night shift is a day off. A day shift is never placed directly before a night shift.
- No more than **2 working days in a row**. Rest and run-length rules also continue across the border between two rosters.
- People marked as unable to work nights never get night shifts.
- Anesthesiologists and critical-care staff work only at the four middle-site stations and are the only people the Regulation desk draws from the medical team.
- Every crew should have at least one Pro. If people are short, the system fills what it can and reports the gap; it never refuses to build a roster.
- Hours are balanced fairly across the whole calendar month, not only inside one roster.

If something goes wrong

What you see	What to do
Sign-in is refused	Check the username (capital letters, spaces) and password. After 5 wrong tries, wait 15 minutes.
'Session expired - please log in again'	You were signed in for more than 12 hours. Sign in again.
'Waiting for another generation to finish'	Only one roster is built at a time. Keep the page open or come back later.
Generation seems to take very long	A full roster takes about 10 to 15 minutes. If the page was closed or the system restarted, start it again.
Station code already in use	Codes are unique. Choose a different code.
'No employees / stations / ambulances on file yet'	Add at least one of each before generating.
Roster for these dates already exists and is locked	It is submitted or published. Reopen it (submitted only), or choose different dates.
Cannot publish	Run Check conflicts and fix each line, or have a manager record an approved exception.
Anything else	Tell the administrator the screen name, what you pressed and the exact message.

Who to contact

	Name and phone (fill in)
Administrator	
Your own manager	